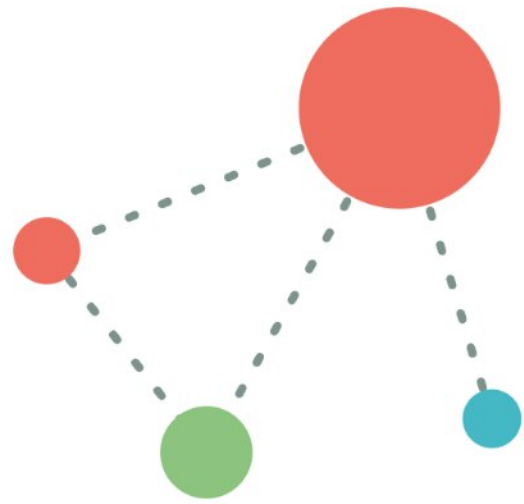
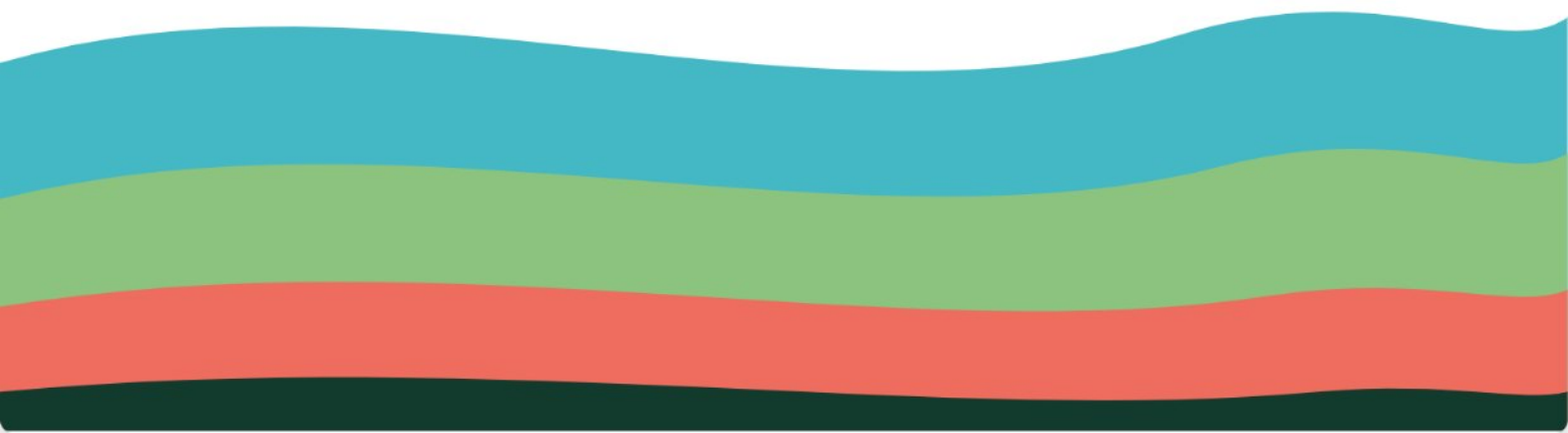




Foundations for working in place

Practice journal

A place for your reflections, notes and ideas.



How to use this journal

This journal accompanies the **Foundations for working in place** course. Use it to capture reflections, questions, sketches and ideas as you move through the learning experience. Write as much or as little as you need.

Why reflect?

Reflection can help you notice what is shaping your thinking, make sense of what you are seeing and decide what you may want to explore next. There is no single right way to reflect — a few notes, a sketch or a question can be enough.

A simple way to reflect

As you move through this learning experience, you might like to use these questions as a starting point. They can help you make sense of what you're noticing and consider what you might explore next.



What?

What happened, or what did I notice?



So what?

Why does it matter?



Now what?

What might I explore, ask or do next?

Learning journey



This map shows the path you'll follow through the learning experience. You'll explore relationships and trust, then local knowledge and lived experience — connecting these ideas to your own work, community and lived experience as you go.

- **Notes and observations**

Who helps shape your place?

Think about a place you care about. It might be a neighbourhood, workplace, school, town, region or community you feel connected to. Write down the people, groups or organisations that help shape this place.

People, groups or organisations

Who helps shape your understanding of this place?

Looking at your selections, are there people, groups or organisations that might still be missing?

- Welcome and introduction

Pause and reflect

Take a moment to capture what stood out to you in the introduction before moving into Module 1.

What stood out to you throughout the introduction?

As you continue, what would you like to pay closer attention to?

Learning journey



In this module you'll explore some of the foundational ideas that support place-based work, including relationships and trust. As you return to Wattlestone, you'll see how different relationships, experiences and perspectives shape what people notice, share and understand about a shared challenge — and explore approaches that help build trust and support participation.

● Notes and observations

Pause and reflect

You've just explored six different perspectives on youth disengagement. Each person noticed something different because of the relationships they have, the experiences they bring and the role they play in the community. Before moving on, reflect on your own context.

- **Where do you hear about change before it appears in reports or meetings?**
- **Who do people naturally turn to when something important is happening?**
- **Whose perspectives are hardest to hear in your community or workplace?**
- **What helps people feel comfortable sharing what they know and contributing their perspectives?**

Which actions help build trust?

Consider each action and sort where you think it belongs. Remember that trust develops over time through ongoing relationships and consistent ways of working.

Holding one community meeting

Acting on what you hear

Creating a partnership agreement

Being honest about challenges

Running a one-off consultation

Following through on commitments

Holding a single co-design workshop

Sharing regular updates

Creating a steering committee without ongoing engagement

Listening to local perspectives

Builds trust over time

Actions that show consistency, care and follow-through.

Can help, but isn't enough alone

Actions that may help, but need relationships around them.

Pause and reflect

Throughout this module you've explored how people bring different knowledge, experiences and perspectives to understand a place, and how relationships and trust support shared understanding. Think about a conversation, meeting or partnership you've been part of recently, and capture a few thoughts in whatever way works best for you.

- **What helps people feel comfortable contributing their perspectives?**
- **How do you create space for different perspectives to be heard in your work or community?**
- **Who might need more support or time before they feel able to participate?**
- **What could you do to strengthen trust in one relationship that matters to your work?**

Learning journey



In Module 1 you explored how relationships shape what people notice and share. In this module you'll explore the different forms of knowledge people bring to place-based work. As you return to Wattlestone, you'll see how different experiences, perspectives and roles contribute to a richer understanding of community.

• Notes and observations

Map your community

Using the Wattlestone map as inspiration, sketch a simple map of a workplace, community or project you know well. As you sketch, consider whose knowledge comes from lived experience, who helps you see everyday life differently, and whose perspective might change how you understand this place.

My community map

A large, empty grid of dots on a light beige background, intended for sketching a community map. The grid consists of small, evenly spaced dots arranged in a rectangular pattern, providing a guide for drawing a map.

Pause and reflect

Deep listening invites us to notice perspectives that might otherwise be overlooked. Capture a few thoughts in whatever way works best for you.

- **What did Tahlia's perspective help you understand that wasn't visible on the community map?**
- **What assumptions about Wattlestone did Tahlia's perspective challenge?**
- **Who else would you want to hear from to build a more complete picture of Wattlestone?**

Optional practice

If it feels appropriate, consider having a conversation with someone whose experience or perspective differs from your own. You might ask:

- **What helps you understand what's happening here?**
- **What do people often overlook?**
- **What do you wish others understood about this place?**

Afterwards, reflect in your journal

What surprised you? What did this conversation help you understand? How might it influence the way you listen or work with others?

Learning journey



You've completed **Foundations for working in place**. Throughout this experience you've explored how relationships, trust and different forms of knowledge shape place-based work. It's an ongoing practice — these ideas become meaningful through everyday conversations, relationships and the decisions you make alongside communities. Keep noticing whose knowledge is recognised, whose voices are heard, and where listening more deeply might change how you understand a place.

• Notes and observations

- Summary and next steps

Pause and reflect

Before you finish, take a few minutes to capture a few thoughts in whatever way works best for you.

What idea, story or activity has stayed with you most?

How has your understanding of place-based work changed?

What's one small thing you'll do differently in your work or community?

Keep the conversation going

Place-based work continues to evolve through practice, relationships and learning from one another. This is the first of a series of learning experiences we're developing to support place-based practice.

We'd love to hear how these ideas connect with your own experience — and what you'd like to explore next. If you have questions, feedback or examples from your own work, please get in touch.

Contact us

enable@placeaustralia.org

Your feedback will help shape future learning experiences for people working in place.

